

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr IZZET ERTAS

Address: 219 Malden Road Cheam SM3 8EL

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: Dear Sir/Madam,

I am writing in strong support of the above planning application. I am a Muslim resident living approximately two miles from the proposed site and have lived in this borough for [X] years.

The Muslim population in this area has grown significantly in recent years, yet there is a clear shortage of adequate spaces for worship and community gathering. Existing facilities are overcrowded and unable to meet demand, particularly during Friday prayers, Ramadan, and Eid. Many of us travel considerable distances simply to find a mosque with sufficient capacity, which is neither practical nor sustainable - especially for elderly residents and families with young children. This proposal would address that need while also benefiting the wider neighbourhood. Community hubs of this nature routinely offer services open to all residents, including educational programmes, youth activities, interfaith events, and social support. Far from being exclusive, mosques and Islamic centres across the UK are among the most outward-facing community institutions, regularly opening their doors to neighbours of all backgrounds.

Converting a vacant former ambulance station into an active community facility is a sensible and sustainable use of the site. It is worth noting that the previous use generated far more traffic - large emergency vehicles operating 24 hours a day - than a community and worship facility ever would. I respectfully urge the planning committee to approve this application and recognise the positive contribution it will make to our area.

Yours faithfully,